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She also warns against diets that encourage miracle pills, weight loss supplements or metabolism boosters. “They do not work. In fact they may cause a lot of damage. So [they’re] not even worth trying,” she warns.

Of course, with everyone looking for a quick fix, weight loss products have a huge market globally. According to the analysis firm Research and Markets, the global market for weight loss products and services was valued at \$254.9 billion in 2021 and is expected to hit \$377.3 billion by 2026.

So what works and what doesn’t?

Mediterranean Diet

The *U.S. News & World Report* ranked the Mediterranean diet—which is rich in whole vegetables, fresh fruit, whole grains, fatty fish, olive oil, nuts, legumes, and dairy, its No. 1 overall diet in 2022, out of 40 diets. “It’s not a fad diet. It’s a way of life, just like the Indian way of diet. It’s a very balanced way of eating and takes care of every single food group,” says Devgan who recommends you follow it if you are

looking at overhauling your way of eating.

“By default, if you eat more of healthier foods rich in fibre and protein, the bad foods with saturated fats and sugar will automatically get crowded out. After all, there is only this much you can eat in a day. So don’t try and remove foods from your diet, just keep adding the good stuff.”

The Mediterranean diet also has other health benefits. A study published in the US of nearly 26,000 women, found that those who followed the Mediterranean diet closely

had up to a 28 per cent lower risk of heart disease compared with those who didn’t follow the diet, primarily because the diet helped lower inflammation, improve insulin function, and reduce body mass index (BMI).

Intermittent Fasting

Intermittent fasting or time-restrictive eating is an eating pattern that swings between periods of eating nothing (fasting) and eating regular meals. “We didn’t call it intermittent fasting but we have been recommending it for a long time. Ayurveda